

# The Boston Globe

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## SJC keeps Quincy's saintly statues in storage

Mayor's attempt to have them adorn building runs into church-state block

By Sean Cotter  
and John R. Ellement

GLOBE STAFF

The mayor of Quincy's controversial quest to install two 10-foot-tall bronze statues of Catholic saints at a city building hit a major roadblock Thursday when the state's highest court ruled against him in a case that's drawn national attention as a tension point in the long-running

debate over the separation of church and state.

The 34-page ruling is not the final word on the statues of St. Michael and St. Florian, who are associated with police and firefighters, respectively. Technically, the Supreme Judicial Court's ruling affirmed a lower-court judge's decision to temporarily halt installation of the statues while a lawsuit against

the city moves forward.

But the ruling will keep the two large statues, whose renderings portray the saints in victory poses that show off rippling abs, in storage. And, the SJC was clear in its skepticism of Mayor Thomas Koch's push, writing that the opponents of the statues are likely to succeed in the lawsuit.

It's likely Quincy "has violated important constitutional rights and has spent, and plans to continue to spend, taxpayer dollars in violation of those rights that will not be recov-

erable," Supreme Judicial Court Associate Justice Scott L. Kafker wrote in a unanimous decision.

Even so, Koch vowed to fight on. "Quincy's firefighters and police put their lives on the line for this city every day, and these statues were chosen to honor their bravery, service, and sacrifice," Koch's spokesperson wrote in an email to the Globe after the ruling. "This decision is disappointing, but it is preliminary, and we will continue to fight for the ability to commemorate

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## Concerns over Flock detection intensify

Four officers accused of misusing camera data

By Yogev Toby

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

For the third time in a week, police officers in Massachusetts were caught misusing Flock Safety's license plate camera network, raising questions about the lack of oversight of the surveillance technology that has quickly and quietly sprouted up across the country.

Two officers in Lynn were placed on leave after an audit flagged a "concerning pattern" in their Flock searches, officials said Wednesday. A day earlier, Stow police said they would move to fire an officer and criminally charge him for allegedly tracking his ex-girlfriend. That followed New Bedford police placing an officer on leave who was accused of stalking her ex-girlfriend.

The misconduct was identified after a growing nationwide backlash prompted action on a number of fronts. People have been using a website, HaveIBeenFlocked.com, to learn if their license plates had been the target of a Flock search; the company rolled out a system that is supposed to flag questionable searches; and towns and police departments have started to tighten access and clamp down on misuse.

"We want to make sure that the privacy concerns are taken care of and that we still have this

FLOCK, Page A7



PHOTOS BY JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

People gathered in solidarity outside Plymouth Superior Court Thursday to support Lindsay Clancy and her family.

## 'Bearing witness' for, by mothers

Tribulations and trial of Clancy resonate with group of court spectators

By Chloe Craft

GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

PLYMOUTH — Each day the trial of Lindsay Clancy resumes, a small group of spectators, mostly women, settles among the gallery to bear silent witness on behalf of mothers who have struggled with their mental health after giving birth.

Some work in the health care field; others include an airline employee, a stay-at-home mom, a real estate agent, and a retiree. Almost all are mothers from New England who are spending their free time at the courthouse because they, or someone they cared about, experienced postpartum anxiety, depression, or other perinatal mental health conditions and feel it is important to humanize the Clancy family's story.

"I find myself resonating with Lindsay herself, from what we're learning about her and what she went through," said Sarah Ba-



Christine Sargent of Pembroke (right) cried as she was hugged by Mary Petitto from Rehoboth at the gathering.

roud, 43, a licensed clinical social worker with two children who struggled with postpartum depression after the birth of her first child and postpartum anxiety with the second. She said she

had attended three days of the trial.

This show of support was underscored on Thursday morning when hundreds of demonstrators clad in pink gathered out-

►A hospital chaplain testified of talking with Lindsay Clancy about her children. B1.

side the courthouse for an event they termed, "Stand in Peace for Lindsay." The sizable showing evoked the sometimes boisterous demonstrations on behalf of Karen Read during her trial for allegedly killing her boyfriend, a Boston police officer.

Inside the courtroom on most days, the group shared pictures of their children during breaks and talked about their own struggles with motherhood and mental health or what they saw as gaps in the health care system.

And, like many who attended the demonstration Thursday, some had a sense that the woman at the center of the case was subjected to an unfair attack on her personal character designed to maximize the more sensation-

SUPPORTERS, Page A7

## Milton alters residency test amid criticism

Role of police in checking students still contentious

By John Hilliard

GLOBE STAFF

MILTON — School officials disclosed this week they will take some steps to change how the district conducts residency checks of students amid tensions over a Boston Globe report that found Black students were disproportionately scrutinized over whether they live in town.

Interim Superintendent John Phelan told the Milton School Committee Wednesday night the district will end the use of an anonymous tip line for residency investigations and improve its data collection to include factors such as students' race and housing conditions.

The changes are not likely to completely appease families angry over the town's methods for verifying residency cases, as they also want Milton to stop using police to surveil children's homes and search residences for students' bedrooms as part of their investigations.

Phelan has defended the town's handling of the investigations and said Milton doesn't discriminate or target any students or families based on race. He has acknowledged that some groups of students are overrepresented in residency investigations and removals.

"I want to make sure that we're doing this in a way [that's] thoughtful, but also by the law and to

MILTON, Page A6

## For incoming students, a tower of green power

BU unveils first stage of dorm overhaul with less emissions, more amenities

By Michaela Towfighi

GLOBE STAFF

The largest dorm in Boston has remained largely unchanged since it was built in 1965, with cracked vinyl floors, little insulation, and no air conditioning. But this week, students at Boston University will move into the first of three renovated towers, bringing the building into the 21st century and advancing the school's climate action plan.

The first phase of a \$550 million overhaul to Warren Towers, which houses 1,800

students on Commonwealth Avenue, was completed this month. The second and third towers, along with renovations to the streetscape, are projected to be finished by 2029. The university said the building is the second-largest non-military dorm in the country, behind Jester Center at the University of Texas Austin, which houses nearly 3,200 students.

The newly renovated tower includes housing for 600 students in single, double, and triple dorm rooms, as well as sev-

DORM, Page A5



JOHN TLUMACKI/GLOBE STAFF

Work on Tower A of Warren Towers is complete and freshmen will be living there. Work continues on Tower B (right).



### Weak end forecast

**Friday:** Cooler, some showers. High 71-76, low 64-69.

**Saturday:** More showers.

Sunrise: 5:58. Sunset: 7:36.

Weather and comics, **G6-7**.  
Obituaries, **C9**.

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**The first group of US deportees arrived in Liberia,** where critics are denouncing the government's deal with the Trump administration to take them. **A3.**

**It's been a rich, exuberant, and sometimes unwieldy 150 years** for the School of the Museum of Fine Arts at Tufts University and a winding celebration captures that. **G1.**

**How will the fans react to Rafael Devers's return to Fenway** Friday for the first time since he was traded, Peter Abraham asks. **C1.**

**Senator Ed Markey and Representative Seth Moulton traded barbs** in their final debate before the primary. **B1.**